MRK HOTELS

Printer Setup Guide

The reliable way — CUPS & Windows, step by step

Windows · macOS · Linux

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The whole job in five steps

Follow these five steps and your printer is ready. Each one is explained slowly, further down.

1. **Plug in** the printer and switch it on.
2. **Add the printer to your computer** — Part 2 (Windows), Part 3 (Mac) or Part 4 (Linux).
3. **Print a test page** to prove the computer can see the printer.
4. **Install the MRK printer helper** on the computer the printer is plugged into.
5. **In MRK**, open *Printer Settings*, choose *Network printer*, paste the address, press *Test Print*.

What is CUPS? (in plain words)

CUPS is the printing manager built into Mac and Linux. Think of it as the front desk of a hotel: you tell it about the printer **once**, and from then on it takes every receipt and hands it to the printer in the language the printer understands.

On **Windows** the same job is done by Windows itself, so you do not install CUPS there — you simply add the printer in Windows. This guide shows you both, in plain language.

> **Why are we not using "Serial"?**
>
> The earlier **Serial** method tried to talk to the printer directly, and it could not find your printer. CUPS (and Windows' own printer system) uses the printer's proper **driver**, so it sees the printer correctly. This is the reliable route — and it is already built into your computer, so there is nothing extra to buy.

Before you start

Check that you have everything on this list. Keep the printer switched on and the paper roll loaded the whole time.

What you need	A little more detail
The receipt printer	Your thermal receipt printer, e.g. the Romeson RM80ZJ or similar.
The power cable	Plugged into a working wall socket.
The USB cable (or network cable)	Connects the printer to the computer.
The computer	The one the printer is plugged into. Keep it switched on to print.
Chrome or Edge browser	Any modern browser works for this guide.
About 15 minutes	Pour a cup of tea first.

Not sure which computer to use?

Use the computer that the printer's cable is plugged into. We call it **"the printer's computer"** below.

Part 1 — Plug in the printer

1. Put the printer on a stable surface near the computer.
2. Plug the **power cable** into the printer and the wall, then press the printer's power button. The light should come on.
3. Load the **paper roll** and close the lid.
4. Plug the **USB cable** into the printer and into the computer. (If you use a network cable instead, plug it in and skip the USB.)
5. Leave everything switched on.

Tip

If the printer has a small self-test button, you can press it once to print a test slip. That proves the printer itself is healthy before we set up the computer.

Using a network (Ethernet) cable instead of USB

Some printers — including the one in this hotel — have a **network socket** as well as USB. You can plug the printer into the network instead of a computer's USB port. When you do, the printer needs its own **fixed IP address** (for example `192.168.1.200`), and the helper is told that address so it can send receipts over the cable. Receipt printers almost always listen on port **9100**. The helper's **set-network-printer.bat** does this for you (Part 5).

Part 2 — Windows (the printer's computer)

Windows

Windows has its **own** printing system, so you do **not** install CUPS here. You simply add the printer, and Windows does the rest.

1. Click **Start**, then type **Printers & scanners** and open it.
2. Click **Add device** (or **Add a printer or scanner**).
3. Wait a moment while Windows looks for the printer.
4. If your printer appears in the list, click **Add device** next to it.
5. If it does **not** appear, click **Add manually** and choose one of these: - **Add a printer using an IP address or hostname** — for a printer connected by network cable. - **Add a local printer or network printer with manual settings** — for a USB printer.
6. Follow the prompts. Windows will install the **driver** (the printer's software).
7. When it finishes, open **Printers & scanners**, click your printer, and press **Print test page**.

If Windows asks for a driver, or the printer is shared

Use the disc or USB stick that came with the printer, or download the driver from the maker's website. If the printer is shared from a **Linux or Mac** computer, choose **Add manually → Add a printer using an IP address or hostname** and type the shared address your support team gives you (it looks like `http://192.168.1.50:631/printers/ReceiptPrinter`).

Part 3 — Mac

macOS

Mac computers are **powered by CUPS inside**. The friendly screen below is just the easy face of CUPS.

1. Click the **Apple menu** (top-left) → **System Settings**.
2. Open **Printers & Scanners**.
3. Click **Add Printer, Scanner, or Fax…**
4. Find your printer in the list on the left (it usually appears by name, e.g. "Romeson RM80ZJ"). Click it.
5. Check the **Use** box says the printer's name. Click **Add**.
6. The printer now appears in the list. Make sure it is set as the **default** (right-click → Set Default).
7. Click **Print Test Page** to try it.

Part 4 — Linux (the CUPS way)

Linux

On Linux, CUPS is the printer system, and it has its own simple web page you can open in your browser.

1. Make sure the printer is plugged in and switched on (Part 1).
2. Open **Chrome** or **Edge** and type this address, then press Enter: **http://localhost:631**
3. Click the **Administration** tab at the top.
4. Click the **Add Printer** button.
5. If a small box asks for a **username** and **password**, type your computer's own login (the one you use to sign in). Then Continue.
6. Under **Local Printers**, click your printer's name. If you do not see it, choose: - **AppSocket/HP JetDirect** — for a printer plugged in by network cable. - **LPD/LPR Host or Printer** — another common network option. Then type the printer's address and click Continue.
7. In **Name**, type **ReceiptPrinter**. You can also fill in Description and Location.
8. Tick the box **Share This Printer**.
9. Click **Continue**.
10. For **Make**, choose **Raw** (this is the best choice for receipt printers). Click **Continue**.

11. On the **Set Default Options** page, choose the paper size for the roll (look for an **80mm** or *Roll* size). Click **Set Default Options**.

12. You are back on the **Printers** page. Click your printer, then **Maintenance → Print Test Page**.

Important

When CUPS asks for a password, it means **your computer's own username and password** — not a new password and not your MRK password. If you never set one, ask whoever set up the computer.

Make it the main printer

On the **Printers** page, open your printer and click **Set As Server Default**. That way it is used automatically.

Part 5 — Install the MRK printer helper (all computers)

All systems

The **helper** (we also call it the **bridge**) lives on the printer's computer. It quietly passes each receipt from MRK to the printer. You install it **once**.

1. On the printer's computer, open MRK → **Printer Settings → Setup guide & printer helper** and click **Printer helper (printer-bridge.zip)**. Then **unzip** it (for example to `C:\mrk-printer-bridge`).

2. **On Windows:** right-click the file **install-start.bat** and choose **Run as administrator**. This is a one-time job.

3. That's it. The helper starts with the computer every time it is switched on — nothing else to click.

If the printer uses a network (Ethernet) cable

Do the three steps above first, then **right-click** `set-network-printer.bat` and run it. Type the printer's IP address when asked (press Enter to accept port `9100`). The helper then prints straight to the printer over the network — no USB and no Windows driver needed.

On Mac and Linux

Your MRK support team will give you the matching helper for your system. The idea is exactly the same: start it once and leave it running in the background.

Part 6 — Tell MRK to use the printer

1. Sign in to **MRK Hotels**.
2. Open the **cashier** area, then open **Printer Settings**.
3. In the **Add printer** row, choose **Network bridge agent**.
4. In the address box, type the address of the printer's computer, for example: **http://192.168.1.50:9720**
5. Click **Add**.
6. Press **Test Print**. A small receipt should come out of the printer.

How to find the computer's address (its "IP address")

Windows: Settings → **Network & internet** → click your connection → **Properties** → find **IPv4 address**. **Mac:** System Settings → **Network** → **Details** → **IP Address**. **Linux:** System Settings → **Network** → the address shown for your connection. It looks like four numbers, such as `192.168.1.50`. Use it in the step above, followed by `:9720`.

Part 7 — If something is not working

Find your problem in the left column and try the fix on the right. Go slowly, one line at a time.

What you see	What to try
The printer is not in the list	Check the power light is on and the cable is pushed in. Try a different USB port. Switch the printer off, wait 10 seconds, and on again.
CUPS asks for a password	Type your **computer's** username and password (not your MRK login).
The test page is blank or prints strange characters	That is normal for a "raw" test page. Try the **Test Print** inside MRK instead — that one is the real receipt.
MRK's Test Print does nothing	Make sure the **helper** is running, the address ends with **:9720**, both computers are on the same network, and the helper's port is allowed through the firewall.
The printer is on a network cable and still nothing	Give the printer a fixed IP, run **set-network-printer.bat** on the helper computer and enter that IP. Check `http://localhost:9720/health` — it should say `"transport":"network"`.
The receipt is very long, or blank	Set the paper size to the **80mm roll** in your printer settings and try again.
It prints on one computer but not another	The **helper** must run on the **printer's** computer, and every other computer must use that computer's address.

Finding the helper

On Windows, look in the **system tray** (bottom-right) or in **Task Manager** for **MRK** while it is running. If it is not there, run **install-start.bat** again as administrator.

Words you may see (plain meanings)

Word	What it means
CUPS	The printing manager on Mac and Linux. Your computer's "front desk" for printers.
Driver	The little piece of software that teaches the computer how to talk to one printer.
Printer queue	The list of jobs waiting to print, managed by the computer.
ESC/POS	The printing language receipt printers understand.
Thermal printer	A printer that prints on heat-sensitive paper, like a till slip — no ink.
IP address	The computer's number on the network, e.g. `192.168.1.50`.
Port (9720)	Like an apartment number on a building — it tells MRK exactly where the helper is listening.
Helper / bridge	The small program that passes receipts from MRK to your printer.

Still stuck?

No problem — help is one message away. When you contact **MRK support**, please include:

1. A **photo** of the printer and its lights.
2. The **exact step number** where it went wrong.
3. Any message shown on the screen (a photo is perfect).

With those three things, we can usually solve it on the first try.